PPP-B-28A
April 20, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PPP-B-0028(GSA-FSS)
September 30, 1965

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BAG, PLASTIC (SANDWICH)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for flexible plastic sandwich bags.

1.2 Classification. The sandwich bags shall be of one type and style.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378 - Plastic Film (Polyethylene Thin Gage)
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-A-148 - Aluminum Foil

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 8105

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein: Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI):

T 410os-68 - Basis Weight
T 483m - Odor of Packaging Materials

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The bags shall be transparent, flexible, unsupported flat sheets or tubular material. The material shall be vinyl and vinylidene chloride copolymer, polyethylene, or polypropylene conforming to the requirements herein.

3.1.1 Certification. The contractor shall furnish the contracting officer a certificate of compliance stating that the materials used to manufacture the bags conform to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended.

3.1.2 Tubing and sheets. Tubing and sheets shall be free of gels, streaks, holes, foreign matter or undispersed raw material.

3.1.3 Film gage. The thickness of the film shall be not less than 0.0008 inch.

3.2 Dimensions. The dimensions of the bag shall be inside measurements, exclusive of seals or seams. The bags shall be not less than 6-1/4 inches wide. The length of the bags shall be no more than 9-1/2 inches including flap, fold or tuck.

3.3 Basis weight. The basis weight of the plastic film shall be 12.75 pounds, 24 x 36-500, 3.1 weight tolerance. Variation tolerance shall be no more than 7 percent above or below the 500 sheet weight.

3.4 Closure. Closure shall be of the manufacturer's normal commercial flap, fold or tuck type.

3.5 Construction. The bags shall be so constructed, that all seams or seals shall adhere securely throughout their area. Surfaces of the face or back, including flap, fold or tuck, shall not adhere to each other during normal storage conditions prior to use.

3.6 Seam or seal strength. The strength of the seams or seals shall be in no case less than 1.5 pounds per inch when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

3.7 Taste and odor. Bags shall have no objectionable odor and shall inpart no objectionable taste or odor to the food packaged therein, when tested in accordance with the applicable method specified in 4.4.2.

3.8 Form (put-up). Bags shall be furnished as individual bags or in rolls.

3.8.1 Individual bags. The bags shall be uniformly folded and arranged in dispenser type boxes.

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3.8.2 Rolls. Rolls of bags furnished in dispenser type boxes, shall be uniformly and smoothly wound on chipboard tubes. The tubes shall be in length, equal to plus 1/4 inch tolerance, of the specified bag widths. The rolls shall be perforated. Perforations shall be straight, continuous and clean cut throughout the width of each bag. The bags shall be easily detached.

3.9 Workmanship. The bags shall be free from defects which affect their appearance, or which may affect their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination, inspection and physical tests, shall be performed using the procedures prescribed by MIL-STD-105.

4.3 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification. In event of conflict, this specification will govern.

4.4 Examination of the end item.

4.4.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined in accordance with the classification of defects set forth in the applicable examination paragraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) in 4.4.1.4. The lot size, for purposes of determining the sample size, shall be expressed in units of packages for examinations under 4.4.1.1 and 4.4.1.2, and in units of shipping containers for examination under 4.4.1.3.

4.4.1.1 Examination of the end item for visual defects and workmanship. The sample unit shall be one bag selected at random, except that not more than five bags shall be taken from any one shipping container.

Examine	Defects
Appearance	Surfaces not clean; dirt spots, slime or oil spots. Tear, cut, puncture, split or scuff mark.
Bags Individual	Bag improperly folded, not arranged neatly for easy dispensing.
Rolls	Chipboard tube missing; perforations missing between bags, not straight or clean cut throughout width of roll.
Workmanship	Seams do not adhere securely throughout their entire area. Bags stick together to the extent that separation or opening causes damage or tearing. Seams not straight or continuous.

4.4.1.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bag.

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Examine	Defects
Dimensions	Length more than specified. Width less than specified.

4.4.1.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects.

Examine	Defects
Packaging	Not in accordance with contract requirements.
Packing	Not level specified; not in accordance with contract requirements. Number of unit packages not as specified. Container material not as specified, closures not accomplished by specified method or materials.
Markings	Illegible, incorrect, imcomplete, omitted, or not in accordance with contract requirements.

4.4.1.4 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for examinations. The inspection levels, for determining the sample size, and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection levels	AQL's
4.4.1.1	S-3	4.0
4.4.1.2	S-2	2.5
4.4.1.3	S-2	4.0

4.4.2 Test methods. The following tests shall be made in accordance with the indicated TAPPI standards. Failure of any test shall be of cause for rejection.

Test	TAPPI Standard
Basis weight	T 410
Taste and odor	T 483

4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Conditioning: The bags shall be conditioned in the standard atmosphere (50 percent relative humidity and 23 degree C. (73 degree F.), for not less than 16 hours before testing.

4.5.2 Film thickness.

4.5.2.1 Apparatus. The apparatus used for this test shall be a micrometer with two plane faces, each with a diameter of 1/4 inch.

4.5.2.2 Procedure. Clamp the specimen between the faces under steady pressure of 23 to 27 pounds per square inch. The distance between the graduations on the dial, shall be such as to permit reading the thickness to 0.0001 inch or less. The micrometer shall be such as to repeat it's readings to within 0.0001 inch on a steel gauge block.

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4.5.3 Seam or seal strength. Seam or seal strength shall be determined, on one inch wide strips of plastic, that have been cut perpendicular to the seam. An electronic or pendulum type tensile tester shall be used to make the determination. The distance between the jaws of the tester at the start of the test shall be two inches. The seam shall be located approximately midway between the two jaws. The cross head speed of the electronic tester shall be set for 20 inches per minute. The operating speed, of the driven head of the pendulum - type instrument, shall be set for approximately 20 inches per minute. The seam or seal strength shall be the tensile force required to break the strip or seal.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A or B. Unless otherwise specified, seventy five (75) bags shall be packaged in a dispenser type paperboard box.

5.1.2 Level C. Bags, in quantities as specified, shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. The bags, in quantities as specified, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box when completely filled of it's content, shall be of such size as to eliminate a void. The box shall be closed and sealed with tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Unless otherwise specified, twenty-four (24) packages shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1, except that the box shall be class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The bags shall be packed to afford adequate protection against physical and environmental damage during shipment, handling and limited storage. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Form, roll or folded (see 3.8).
(c) Quantity per shipping container.
(d) Level of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

Civil Agencies Coordinating activities:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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